

theatre

Past to Present

BANGALORE George Buchner's *Woyzeck* remains one of the most acclaimed works in the annals of theatre. It has been staged by some of the greatest theatre makers in the world including Robert Wilson, besides being filmed by acclaimed filmmakers like Werner Herzog. The play is based on the true story of Johann Christian Woyzeck, a wig-maker and a soldier who, in a fit of jealousy, murdered Christiane Woost, a widow he was living-in with. Woyzeck was later beheaded. It is this celebrated work that Toto Funds the Arts and Rafiki from Bangalore have recreated with their new adaptation. The play is directed by Anmol Vellani. The production is supported by the Goethe Institute/Max Mueller Bhavan, Bangalore.

More than a play, *Woyzeck* has emerged as a comment on the social conditions of the time. Complex themes like morality, jealousy and poverty are explored in the rather lay-

ered structure of the play. *Woyzeck* was left unfinished at the time of Buchner's death. Which is how the last scene of Woyzeck's death has been interpreted differently by different directors over the years. The protagonist, Franz Woyzeck, is a soldier whose life is governed by the actions of others and his reactions to them. His inability to deal with his station in life as well as his "lack of voice" underlie his helplessness. "Woyzeck raises interesting questions about the world we live in. The destabilising effects of the repressive army life and the experiments of the doctor in the play may be seen as a metaphor of the oppression that we face in this regimental world," says Vellani of the adaptation from various translations. Betrayed by his beautiful mistress, and exploited by his captain as well as the doctor in the army, and humiliated by others, Woyzeck's life spirals towards its inevitable end. On September 13 and 14 at Ranga Shankara. The play is scheduled to travel to all the metros shortly.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

REVISITING THE PLAY: A scene from the famous *Woyzeck*



festival

Mixing the Right Beats

DELHI Rock bands are coming to rock you. If you go to inter-colleges festivals, you come across amazing young talents which needs to be trained. Today, most of the professional bands have graduated from being college bands. The 'Big Horn Fest' festival, an initiative by the Performers Collective will bring together bands, which have a large repertoire of self-compositions from varying genres such as Hindi rock, pop, jazz, funk rock, Sufi rock, alternative, blues, Indi-pop, hard rock, fusion and rap metal. "We often get complaints that Indian bands play popular numbers and are not given an opportunity to display their compositional talents, so we took this initiative to showcase talent," says Jack Thomas, founder, Performers Collective. The participating bands include Mrigaya, Advaita and Indie Mist, Level 9, Emperor Minge, Drift, Bandish, Menwhopause, Frequency and Them Clones. From September 10 to 28, At QBA, Chinese & Thai (Gurgaon), Decibel (Samrat Hotel) and Tabula Rasa.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**



ROCKING AWAY: Rock band, Them Clones

exhibition

Taut Imagery

MUMBAI The beauty and power of the stallion has been the muse for Amitesh Verma's creative overture. The fluent lines, flowing geometric form and taut curves of the body, selectively bathed in colour, bring alive the racing horses in his art. *The Stallion Search* is his new series inspired by the divinity in



A piece by Verma

earthly and astral forms. The collection comprises oil, charcoal, graphite and mixed media. At Jehangir Art Gallery from September 9 to 15.

by **Swati Mathur**